

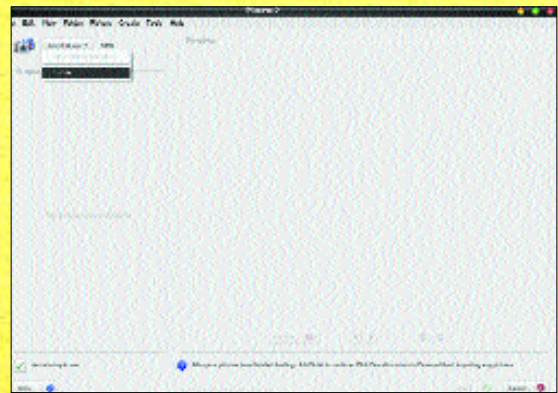
need to be arranged; this is done by cataloguing or categorising.

Cataloguing is the most important step in image management. It decides how fast a particular photograph can be searched from your collection.

There are many ways of categorisation; the simplest is similar to the directory and file structure we have on our computers.

A parent-child relationship exists between the directory and files. The disadvantage of such classification is that a single file cannot be linked to two separate instances unless two copies of the same files are put into two separate folders. This is especially true in the case of photographs, as they are connected to a person on multiple levels such as, the event, the involved people, the place or a variety of factors.

So, if you want to segregate your photographs, you have



Importing photos is a one-step job in Picasa 2

same image. This is achieved by means of 'Tags'.

Tags allow you to append extra information to the same photograph so it can be linked to multiple occasions or people.

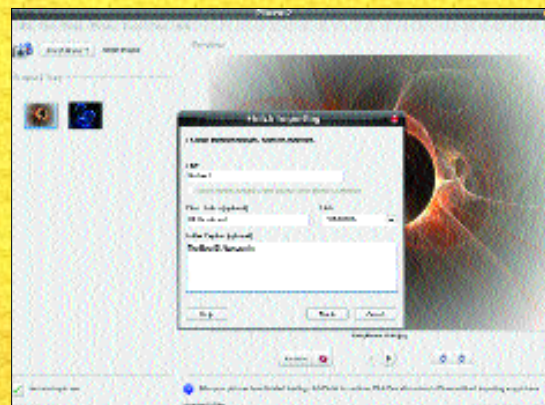
Picasa 2 allows you to add the folder name, captions for the folder, information about the place you shot the photos, and the date at the end of the importing process. This is the first level of categorisation.

Once the photos are arranged in a folder, you can add captions to individual photos too. So, while searching, a filter can be applied for these captions.

For adding tags to a particular photograph in Picasa 2, you need to select it and then click on the 'Label' button in the bottom pane. Every label entry is displayed on the top left hand corner. So for searching, you can go through the label entries, or type in the label or caption.

In Photoshop Album 2.0, once the 'Import' function is completed, images are placed in a temporary folder—Photowell. The next stage is to organise them.

Images can be tagged either by applying pre-defined tags or by creating new ones. You can even create sub-tags under a main cate-



Categorising images in Picasa 2—you can add captions too!

multiple options to consider; should they be categorised under an event, people or place?

To get past this hurdle, you need another method for classification, which runs parallel to the simple directory and file structure and eliminates the need for having multiple copies of the

two main reasons for this.

First, in case of a virus, where your OS fails to boot, a backup of this folder would be required before you can reinstall the OS.

Second, as the 'My Pictures' folder is in the root drive, C:\, the eventual increase in the folder size will slow down your system.

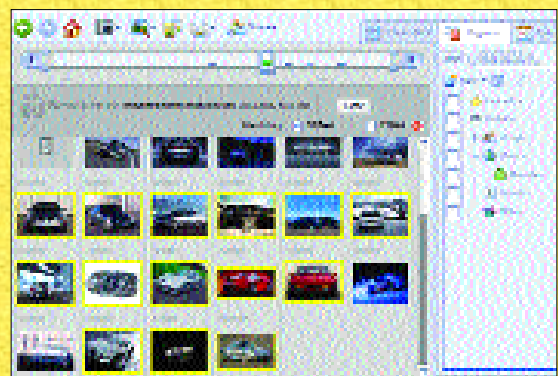
The best option is to create a dedicated folder on a partition of your hard drive, and then set the appropriate path in the image manager. You could even move the entire 'My Documents' folder to a different partition for safety.

Cataloguing

Once you import the images, they

From The Word Go

When you take a photograph with a digital camera, the camera automatically attaches some information related to the photograph to the file. This information is known as meta-data, which includes the date, time, resolution, exposure settings and other technical information. Image management applications often use this information to organise photographs, especially if the manager has a 'Timeline' feature. It is therefore advisable to set the date and time of your camera before you start shooting. All digital cameras allow appending names to the photographs. Clever use of this feature reduces your post-shooting work and also takes care of basic organisation of photos. For example, append 'party' to photos taken at a party, so when you download them, they will automatically be named as party001, party002, and so on.



Adding tags in Photoshop Album 2.0 is a drag-and-drop process